Employer's Tax Guide; Pub. 80, Federal Tax Guide for Employers in the U.S. Virgin islands, Guam, American Samoa, and the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands; and Pub. 179, Guía Contributiva Federal para Patronos Puertorriqueños, have been discontinued. If you prefer Pub. 15 in Spanish, there is a new Pub. 15 (sp) available for 2024.

Unless otherwise noted, references throughout this publication to Form W-2 include Forms W-2AS, W-2CM, W-2GU, W-2VI, and Form 499R-2/W-2PR; references to Form W-2c include Form 499R-2c/W-2cPR; references to Form W-3 include Form W-3SS and Form W-3PR; and references to Form W-3c include Form W-3C (PR).

Social security and Medicare tax for 2024. The rate of social security tax on taxable wages is 6.2% each for the employer and employee. The social security wage base limit is $168,600.

The Medicare tax rate is 1.45% each for the employee and employer, unchanged from 2023. There is no wage base limit for Medicare tax.

Social security and Medicare taxes apply to the wages of household workers you pay $2,700 or more in cash wages in 2024. Social security and Medicare taxes apply to election workers who are paid $2,300 or more in cash or an equivalent form of compensation in 2024.

The COVID-19 related credit for qualified sick and family leave wages is limited to leave taken after March 31, 2020, and before October 1, 2021, and may no longer be claimed on Form 941. Generally, the credit for qualified sick and family leave wages, as enacted under the Families First Coronavirus Response Act (FFCRA) and amended and extended by the COVID-related Tax Relief Act of 2020, for leave taken after March 31, 2020, and before April 1, 2021, and the credit for qualified sick and family leave wages under sections 3131, 3132, and 3133 of the Internal Revenue Code, as enacted under the American Rescue Plan Act of 2021 (the ARP), for leave taken after March 31, 2021, and before October 1, 2021, have expired. However, employers that pay qualified sick and family leave wages in 2024 for leave taken after March 31, 2020, and before October 1, 2021, are eligible to claim a credit for qualified sick and family leave wages in 2024. Effective for tax periods beginning after December 31, 2023, the lines used to claim the credit for qualified sick and family leave wages have been removed from Form 941, Employer's QUARTERLY Federal Tax Return, because it would be extremely rare for an employer to pay wages in 2024 for qualified sick and family leave taken after March 31, 2020, and before October 1, 2021. Instead, if you're eligible to claim the credit for qualified sick and family leave wages because you paid the wages in 2024 for an earlier applicable leave period, file Form 941-X, Adjusted Employer's QUARTERLY Federal Tax Return or Claim for Refund, after filing Form 941, to claim the credit for qualified sick and family leave wages paid in 2024. Filing a Form 941-X before filing a Form 941 for the quarter may result in errors or delays in processing your Form 941-X.

New Forms 941 (sp), 943 (sp), and 944 (sp). If you prefer your form and instructions in Spanish, you can file new Form 941 (sp), new Form 943 (sp), and Form 944 (sp).

Reminders

Qualified small business payroll tax credit for increasing research activities. For tax years beginning before January 1, 2023, a qualified small business may elect to claim up to $250,000 of its credit for increasing research activities as a payroll tax credit. The Inflation Reduction Act of 2022 (the IRA) increases the election amount to $500,000 for tax years beginning after December 31, 2022. The payroll tax credit election must be made on or before the due date of the originally filed income tax return (including extensions). The portion of the credit used against payroll taxes is allowed in the first calendar quarter beginning after the date that the qualified small business filed its income tax return. The election and determination of the credit amount that will be used against the employer's payroll taxes are made on Form 6765, Credit for Increasing Research Activities. The amount from Form 6765, line 44, must then be reported on Form 8974, Qualified Small Business Payroll Tax Credit for Increasing Research Activities.

Starting in the first quarter of 2023, the payroll tax credit is first used to reduce the employer share of social security tax up to $250,000 per quarter and any remaining credit reduces the employer share of Medicare tax for the quarter. Any remaining credit, after reducing the employer share of social security tax and the employer share of Medicare tax, is then carried forward to the next quarter. Form 8974 is used to determine the amount of the credit that can be used in the current quarter. The amount from Form 8974, line 12 or, if applicable, line 17, is reported on Form 941, Form 943, or Form 944. For more information about the payroll tax credit, see *IRS.gov/ResearchPayrollTC*. Also see the line 16 instructions in the Instructions for Form 941 (line 17 instructions in the Instructions for Form 943 or line 13 instructions in the Instructions for Form 944) for information on reducing your record of tax liability for this credit.

Disaster tax relief. Disaster tax relief is available for those impacted by disasters. For more information about disaster relief, go to *IRS.gov/DisasterTaxRelief*.

Payroll tax credit for certain tax-exempt organizations affected by qualified disasters. Section 303(d) of the Taxpayer Certainty and Disaster Tax Relief Act of 2020 allows for a payroll tax credit for certain tax-exempt organizations affected by certain qualified disasters **not** related to COVID-19. This credit is claimed on Form 5884-D (not on Form 941, Form 943, or Form 944). Form 5884-D is filed after the Form 941 for the quarter, Form 943 for the year, or Form 944 for the year for which the credit is being claimed has been filed. For more information about this credit, go to *IRS.gov/Form5884D*.

2024 withholding tables. The Percentage Method and Wage Bracket Method withholding tables, the employer instructions on how to figure employee withholding, and the amount to add to a nonresident alien employee's wages